

Getting Started with Nerva OS

Welcome. You just bought Nerva OS. This guide tells you what it is, what it does, and what to do first.

What is Nerva OS

Nerva OS is a private AI assistant that lives on your computer and runs your business with you.

It is not a chatbot. It is a complete operating system for the boring parts of running a small business. It writes your copy, drafts your emails, researches your competitors, plans your week, and remembers everything about you so it gets sharper every time you use it.

You bought it once. You own it forever. There is no monthly fee from us.

What's Actually in the Box

When you installed Nerva OS, four things landed on your computer.

- 1. 37 skills.** Each skill is a specialist AI worker your assistant can call on. One writes ads. One researches markets. One drafts emails. One plans projects. You'll learn how to use them in tutorial 04.
 - 2. A safety layer.** Built-in rules that stop the assistant from doing anything weird with your money, your customers, or your files without checking with you first.
 - 3. A workspace template.** A folder called `my-assistant` that stores your business memory. Your name, your business, your tone, your customers. This is what makes the assistant feel like it actually works for you.
 - 4. These tutorials.** Plain English guides for getting up and running fast.
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How It's Different from ChatGPT

You might be wondering why this is different to what you already use. Here's the short version.

It lives on your computer. ChatGPT runs on a website. Nerva OS runs locally. Your business information stays on your machine.

It knows your business. ChatGPT starts from zero every conversation. Nerva OS reads your memory file at the start of every session. It knows your name, your industry, your customers, and your tone of

voice.

It remembers everything. Tell it once that you hate em dashes. It never uses one again. Tell it your pricing rules. It applies them to every quote forever.

It can use real tools. ChatGPT can write copy. Nerva OS can write copy, open your browser, log into your tools, and put the copy into your real systems.

It is specialised, not generic. ChatGPT tries to do everything okay. Nerva OS uses the right specialist skill for the job. A copywriting skill writes copy. A research skill does research. The result is sharper, more useful work.

What You Can Do in Your First Week

Here are the things most new owners try in the first few days.

1. Have the assistant interview you about your business. It will save what you tell it.
2. Ask it to write three social posts in your tone of voice.
3. Ask it to research three of your competitors and tell you what they do better.
4. Ask it to draft a follow-up email to a customer who went quiet.
5. Ask it to plan your week and put the plan in writing.
6. Ask it to write a frequently asked questions page for your website.

Each of these takes a few minutes. By the end of the week you'll have proof it works.

What You'll Learn in These Tutorials

There are three tutorials we recommend you read next, in order.

02 — Your First Conversation walks you through opening the assistant and having your first session. Start here.

04 — The Skill System explains how the 37 specialist skills work and how to call them on demand.

09 — Troubleshooting covers the ten most common things that go wrong and how to fix them in under two minutes.

You can read the rest at your own pace. These three get you working.

Where to Get Help

If you get stuck, here are your options in order.

1. **Ask the assistant.** Most problems can be fixed by saying "something isn't working, can you help me figure out what". It will walk you through it.
2. **Check the troubleshooting guide.** Tutorial 09 covers the top ten common issues.
3. **Email us.** Write to support@nerva-os.com with a short description of what you tried and what happened. We answer within one business day.

A Quick Word Before You Start

Nerva OS is built to be calm, slow, and clear. It will not bury you in jargon. It will not throw walls of text at you. If it ever does, tell it to slow down and it will.

You are not expected to be technical. You are expected to be the business owner. The assistant handles the rest.

Next: Open [02 — Your First Conversation](#) and have your first session.
